Volume D | Execution Standard Operating Procedures

This manual guides preparation and proposed future work. It is not an instruction from PSS, a delegation of authority, a regulatory opinion, or proof of a completed validation.

DECISION LIMIT: Before formal appointment and written authority, do not represent PSS, engage banks as PSS, request internal data, issue RFIs, touch live transactions, or approve expenditure.

Use of these procedures and procedural authority

These are proposed operational research SOPs prepared for future discussion, not adopted PSS policy. Actual PSS policy, NBE requirements, data-protection duties, contractual obligations and approved delegations take precedence. Every SOP lists its evidence before authorisation and its stop condition.

Gate type	Work may proceed only when
Desk research	Source is public or already legitimately held; no representation of PSS.
Internal interview/access	Written mandate, least privilege, approved classification and named custodians.
Bank/merchant contact	Institutional outreach approval, privacy/consent process and defined research scope.
Technical system test	Change-controlled environment, access and security approval.
Supplier interaction	Approved sourcing process, conflicts review and RFI authorisation.
Production/pilot/capital	Separate legal, technical, finance, governance and executive approval gates.

SOP-01 | Request research mandate

Use: S04/V01; personal role/appointment record

Mandatory precondition: Written appointment and delegated access scope

1. Prepare one-page problem and decision request from S01/S04.
2. Identify sponsor, scope, budget cap if any, exclusions and stop date.
3. Have HR/Legal confirm authority and official circulation route.
4. Submit for a written decision and record conditions.
5. Record refusal/deferral as a stop, not tacit consent.

Completion record: Signed research TOR and named sponsor; no direct bank contact unless separately permitted.

If blocked: Log Pending/Blocked and reviewer/owner; do not route around access, scheme, legal, security or investment controls.

SOP-02 | Request classified evidence

Use: S03/V05, F02–F05 data registers

Mandatory precondition: Mandate + minimum necessary data handling controls

6. Write specific field, time range, intended test and legal purpose.
7. Ask owner and security lead for the least-privilege method.
8. Confirm data retention, location, redaction and permitted use.
9. Log exact source locator; restrict exports and access.
10. Return/revoke access at expiry and note exceptions.

Completion record: Authorised evidence ID, purpose, custodian and dated retention decision.

If blocked: Log Pending/Blocked and reviewer/owner; do not route around access, scheme, legal, security or investment controls.

SOP-03 | Refresh primary public sources

Use: V02 Sources; F03 Source Register; Master Source Refresh

Mandatory precondition: Personal research permitted; official circulation reviewed

11. Open original issuer page and note publication and retrieval dates.
12. Record whether instrument is draft, effective, repealed or guidance.
13. Compare prior claim against current source and denominators.
14. Log changed facts as source-refresh and change-control entries.
15. Do not silently update baseline numbers in unrelated models.

Completion record: Source register entry and controlled impact note.

If blocked: Log Pending/Blocked and reviewer/owner; do not route around access, scheme, legal, security or investment controls.

SOP-04 | Validate a public PSS capability claim

Use: S03; V05; F02; P01

Mandatory precondition: Authorised current-state assessment

16. Identify exact product, version, claimed function and source.
17. Request installed-system evidence, environment scope and owner.
18. Inspect documented logs/demos only with authority.
19. Separate prototype, test, customer use and third-party certificate scope.
20. Update reuse classification and remaining gaps.

Completion record: Owner-verified capability map or explicit unverified status.

If blocked: Log Pending/Blocked and reviewer/owner; do not route around access, scheme, legal, security or investment controls.

SOP-05 | Run bank buyer discovery

Use: V03; F04; S02

Mandatory precondition: Approved engagement scope and consent

21. Confirm interview invite, role and consent script.
22. Ask for measurable current reconciliation and support losses.
23. Verify economic buyer, budget sponsor and procurement path.
24. Test fees and alternatives without leading questions.
25. File an anonymised record and buyer evidence level.

Completion record: Real buyer proof, bank ROI baseline, dissent and conditional sponsor status.

If blocked: Log Pending/Blocked and reviewer/owner; do not route around access, scheme, legal, security or investment controls.

SOP-06 | Run merchant concept fieldwork

Use: V04; V02

Mandatory precondition: Approved sampling, privacy and informed consent

26. Use quotas and approved recruitment.
27. Observe payment methods and dispute/reconciliation problems.
28. Present four concepts neutrally in a consistent order or rotated protocol.
29. Record actual merchant words and negatives; avoid confidential transaction identifiers.
30. Code and review hypotheses with a second analyst.

Completion record: Anonymised notes, coded problems and no unjustified population projection.

If blocked: Log Pending/Blocked and reviewer/owner; do not route around access, scheme, legal, security or investment controls.

SOP-07 | Update product scope and priority

Use: P01; V03–V05

Mandatory precondition: Verified user evidence and product owner review

31. Trace every requested feature to a real pain and buyer.
32. Set module ownership and read-only evidence boundary.
33. Identify accept vs defer/reject and quantitative acceptance criterion.
34. Link interface/security controls and estimated operating cost.
35. Issue documented product change and owner sign-off.

Completion record: Versioned P01 requirement and acceptance-test ID.

If blocked: Log Pending/Blocked and reviewer/owner; do not route around access, scheme, legal, security or investment controls.

SOP-08 | Verify integration and evidence state

Use: P02; F02

Mandatory precondition: PSS technical scope and approved test environment

36. Review permitted source feed and interface credentials under least privilege.
37. Map event ID, source, timestamp, outcome, reversal and settlement status.
38. Test duplicate/replay/out-of-order/unknown outcomes using controlled cases.
39. Compare reconciled result with bank source-of-truth ledger and authorisation logs.
40. Record defects and retest before design gate clearance.

Completion record: Traceable negative and successful test outputs, independent technical reviewer.

If blocked: Log Pending/Blocked and reviewer/owner; do not route around access, scheme, legal, security or investment controls.

SOP-09 | Protect multi-bank data

Use: P02 Controls/Threats; F02

Mandatory precondition: CISO-approved technical test plan

41. Classify tenants, roles, keys and support users.
42. Attempt cross-tenant record retrieval under authorised negative tests.
43. Verify audit logging, revocation and backup access.
44. Document severity, containment and retest; stop on leakage.
45. Obtain CISO disposition before any live use.

Completion record: Tenant isolation test report and current risk decision.

If blocked: Log Pending/Blocked and reviewer/owner; do not route around access, scheme, legal, security or investment controls.

SOP-10 | Confirm legal perimeter

Use: F03; P03

Mandatory precondition: Legal counsel and original instrument/contract access

46. Map each proposed action to responsible authorised institution.
47. Review actual licences, scheme contracts and processor roles.
48. Confirm lawful basis and access permissions for each data field.
49. Check 2026 cyber/critical infrastructure applicability and required notifications.
50. Record lawyer's scope-limited interpretation, exceptions and sign-off.

Completion record: Service-by-service legal permission matrix or hold.

If blocked: Log Pending/Blocked and reviewer/owner; do not route around access, scheme, legal, security or investment controls.

SOP-11 | Validate operating roles

Use: P03; F03

Mandatory precondition: Formal RACI review with real owners

51. Walk through onboarding, event mismatch, reversal, dispute and incident.
52. Require bank and PSS owners to identify decision rights, SLA and escalation.
53. Keep financial settlement and remedies with authorised actors.
54. Record non-accepted handoffs and contract dependencies.
55. Update versioned operating model and acceptance conditions.

Completion record: Signed RACI or unresolved gap list.

If blocked: Log Pending/Blocked and reviewer/owner; do not route around access, scheme, legal, security or investment controls.

SOP-12 | Evaluate reuse, build, buy and partner

Use: P04; P01/P02; S02

Mandatory precondition: Sourcing permission; conflict checks

56. Begin with no-build and actual existing PSS reuse.
57. Screen PSS Trading and specialists using identical hard gates.
58. Obtain legal RFI authorisation before external contact.
59. Collect comparable five-year scope, ownership, IP, portability and exit terms.
60. Run conflict/related-party review and decision evidence.

Completion record: Comparable eligible shortlist or no-procurement conclusion.

If blocked: Log Pending/Blocked and reviewer/owner; do not route around access, scheme, legal, security or investment controls.

SOP-13 | Build bank economic case

Use: V03; F04

Mandatory precondition: Authorised buyer baseline and Finance input

61. Quantify bank's reconciliation/support baseline from dated records.
62. Conservatively attribute avoidable cost and incremental margin.
63. Include bank implementation and retained bank costs.
64. Test real fee ceiling with economic budget owner.
65. Escalate negative buyer net benefit; do not offset with PSS margin.

Completion record: Bank-approved or evidence-limited ROI schedule.

If blocked: Log Pending/Blocked and reviewer/owner; do not route around access, scheme, legal, security or investment controls.

SOP-14 | Build PSS operating unit economics

Use: V05; F04

Mandatory precondition: Finance-approved operating data

66. Separate onboarding, recurring fees and transaction/usage components.
67. Calculate service fixed and variable expense incl cyber, DR and manual work.
68. Reconcile prices against contract rights and taxes.
69. Model zero-client months with persistent OPEX.
70. Check positive sustainable contribution under verified demand.

Completion record: Finance-reviewed price floor and cost-to-serve.

If blocked: Log Pending/Blocked and reviewer/owner; do not route around access, scheme, legal, security or investment controls.

SOP-15 | Appraise five-option capital decision

Use: F05; S02/P04

Mandatory precondition: CFO-certified inputs, finance sign-off

71. Use same horizon, nominal ETB and tax treatment for options A–E.
72. Model 60-month cash, financing, delays, supplier costs and FX.
73. Calculate NPV, IRR where meaningful, payback and peak funding need.
74. Stress lower bank count, price ceilings and cost overruns; independently reperform.
75. Keep hard gates separate from financial ranks.

Completion record: CFO-certified scenarios or indeterminate investment case.

If blocked: Log Pending/Blocked and reviewer/owner; do not route around access, scheme, legal, security or investment controls.

SOP-16 | Commission independent assurance

Use: F06; F01

Mandatory precondition: Management commission and reviewer independence

76. Agree review scope, competence, conflicts and access restrictions.
77. Provide sources with permitted classification and no pre-judged conclusion.
78. Require challenge of bank economics, PSS reuse, legal authority, finance and BAU.
79. Track dissent, evidence gaps, retests and auditor response.
80. Obtain dated signed opinion or document inability to opine.

Completion record: Scope-limited independent assurance opinion or Not Assessed.

If blocked: Log Pending/Blocked and reviewer/owner; do not route around access, scheme, legal, security or investment controls.

SOP-17 | Update integrated feasibility decision

Use: F01; all instruments

Mandatory precondition: Prior gate evidence and independent review

81. Update dimension-by-dimension fact status with source IDs.
82. Retain alternatives and formal stop conditions.
83. Show unresolved legal/security/negative bank value separately from weighted scores.
84. Draft only the decision permitted by current evidence.
85. Record executive decision and restrictions verbatim with signatures.

Completion record: Versioned F01 or defer/reject decision with authority.

If blocked: Log Pending/Blocked and reviewer/owner; do not route around access, scheme, legal, security or investment controls.

SOP-18 | Operate change and version control

Use: Master Control: Change Control; Source manifest

Mandatory precondition: Personal log or institutionally delegated editor

86. Open change request, affected document ID and reason.
87. Log source claim, evidence type, reviewer and downstream impacts.
88. Edit a copy and retain old baseline plus exact files/hashes.
89. Check references, formulas, PDF pair and cross-document consistency.
90. Issue new version only under approved review and circulation.

Completion record: Change record, new version, hash and disposition.

If blocked: Log Pending/Blocked and reviewer/owner; do not route around access, scheme, legal, security or investment controls.

SOP-19 | Record meetings, decisions and dissent

Use: Master Decision Log; V05 notebook

Mandatory precondition: Permitted participants and information handling

91. Write date, scope, attendee role and meeting classification.
92. Separate facts, interpretation, proposal and approvals.
93. Cite evidence locator for each material assertion.
94. Quote objections and contrary evidence without dilution.
95. Send minutes via authorised channel and request confirmation.

Completion record: Dated meeting note, decisions and open tasks.

If blocked: Log Pending/Blocked and reviewer/owner; do not route around access, scheme, legal, security or investment controls.

SOP-20 | Handle security/privacy incident or legal stop

Use: F02/F03; P03 incident matrix

Mandatory precondition: Applicable incident response and legal escalation

96. Stop work that could increase exposure; do not create a personal incident archive.
97. Alert the authorised PSS security/incident commander and legal function.
98. Preserve logs only under approved incident procedure; minimise access.
99. Do not notify customers/regulators independently unless delegated.
100. Resume only under documented institutional direction.

Completion record: Official incident case ID, containment and clearance.

If blocked: Log Pending/Blocked and reviewer/owner; do not route around access, scheme, legal, security or investment controls.

SOP-21 | Prepare pilot authorisation request

Use: F01; P01/P02/F02/F03/F04/F06

Mandatory precondition: All applicable live-service gates satisfied

101. Define approved bank, scope, synthetic-to-live boundary, metrics and maximum exposure.
102. Show contractual licence, data protection, scheme and cyber clearances.
103. Demonstrate incident/reversal/dispute responsibilities and backout.
104. Attach independently challenged bank/PSS economics.
105. Request separate signed controlled-pilot approval; no automatic production conversion.

Completion record: Dated conditional pilot decision or denial.

If blocked: Log Pending/Blocked and reviewer/owner; do not route around access, scheme, legal, security or investment controls.

SOP-22 | Stop or choose no-investment

Use: S02; F01/F05/F06

Mandatory precondition: Evidence demonstrating failed hard gate or inferior value

106. Capture failed criterion and authentic evidence.
107. Model BAU, vendor and PSS Pay counterfactual on common basis.
108. Document reversible tests vs genuinely terminal legal/security failures.
109. Escalate a no-go/redesign option with a preservation/exit plan.
110. Record signed disposition and communicate only within authority.

Completion record: Defensible stop/defer/BAU decision, not an artificially positive score.

If blocked: Log Pending/Blocked and reviewer/owner; do not route around access, scheme, legal, security or investment controls.

Annex 1 — minimum evidence acceptance checklist

- ☐ Identify precise question and programme document/gate ID.
- ☐ Obtain underlying original, qualified source or controlled trace.
- ☐ Capture issuer, version, date, valid period, bank/product scope and repository locator.
- ☐ Check relevance, completeness, possible conflicting evidence and anonymity requirements.
- ☐ Record reviewer independent of preparation where mandated.
- ☐ Do not erase failed tests, revised assumptions or non-consenting respondents.
- ☐ Assign expiry/refresh date and downstream F01 impact.

Annex 2 — editable meeting and review record

Field	Template value (fill after authorised event)
Record ID / classification	MEET-[date]-[sequence] / allowed access class
Mandate and purpose	Approved research TOR number and exact decision question
Attendees	Role and institution; avoid personal identifiers in public extracts
Facts observed	Source/trace reference; original wording where critical
Assumptions	Marked separately; grounds and alternative hypothesis
Decisions	Decision-maker, exact scope, date, restrictions
Dissent and stop rules	Who challenged, what evidence could overturn it
Actions and sign-off	Task ID, owner, due date, review/confirmation

Annex 3 — manager's "do not cross" boundary

- No official solicitation or bank interviews without authorisation.
- No live bank data, credentials or payment records in the personal package.
- No use of PCI, scheme or regulator standard as proof of PSS certification.
- No presumed permission from a public PSS licence listing to offer new services.
- No proposal claiming independent assurance completed merely because F06 exists.
- No guessed contractual fees, PSS cost data or NPV/IRR presented as factual.
- No unilateral settlement decisions, merchant KYC approval or customer remedy outside authorised institutional roles.
- No capital release, pilot or procurement based solely on preliminary research documentation.